



Veteran Pension Fraud Alert

For veterans, veer naris and next of kin drawing pension through SPARSH / banks.

ACTIVE FRAUD PATTERNS AGAINST PENSIONERS

- Fake 'SPARSH / record office' calls demanding OTP or bank details to 'stop your pension from being blocked'.
- Bogus 'life certificate update' links sent by SMS or WhatsApp that harvest banking credentials.
- 'Arrears released - pay processing fee' letters and calls promising OROP or 7th CPC arrears against an advance payment.
- Fraudsters posing as ECHS staff collecting 'card renewal charges' online.
- 'Digital arrest' video calls with fake police uniforms threatening elderly pensioners into transferring savings.

SPARSH, record offices, ECHS and banks NEVER ask for OTPs, PINs, processing fees or 'verification transfers'. Pension is a right - nobody legitimate charges you to release it.

SAFE PRACTICE FOR PENSION ACCOUNTS

1. Do annual identification only through official channels: SPARSH portal, Jeevan Pramaan, your bank branch or authorised service centres.
2. Type sparsh.defencepension.gov.in in yourself - never follow SMS links.
3. Keep the pension account free of UPI apps if the account holder is not confident using them; use a separate small-balance account for daily spends.
4. Nominate a trusted family member to jointly review the passbook monthly.
5. Any call about pension = hang up, call the record office / bank number from your PPO documents.

REPORT

Helpline 1930 | cybercrime.gov.in | Nearest police station (112) | Your bank's fraud cell | Zila Sainik Welfare Office for guidance.